got to keep it in the super-strength zone and not allow it to morph into a weakness.

We both find that being somewhere in the middle of the scale is the sweet spot for me. I begin to realise that, historically, I tip over the wrong side of the warrior spectrum when the ball is not swinging. We talk about how, in that eventuality, I could try to access the assassin mode – because that is when it is critical that I use skill, patience and detailed thinking to win the battle. At the end of a day's play, Mark asks me where I think I have been on the scale and where I need to be the next day. Sometimes it's just by text. He will just say, 'Remember you were at a seven yesterday – rein it in a bit.' I just read it, log it, not even reply. Sometimes no answer is required. I'm just gathering a series of methods to help check in with myself, carving out an art form that's now taking place in a way I haven't considered before.

With each step in the process – short interactions where simple things are left for me to think about and reinterpret in my own words and thoughts – I become more trusting and more invested. I am beginning to feel like my ceiling might be much higher than I had ever dreamed before. That if I can lessen the capacity to sabotage or implode, I really could become the best bowler in the world. Mark suggests that we use a tape that I can listen to that reinforces calm positivity, a place I can re-access at the top of my mark every time I bowl. Every ball is an isolated event, an opportunity again to think calmly and clearly, to deliver what I want to. He introduces me to a deep applied relaxation process, where I find a way to relax my whole body, calm my mind, tune into my breathing. We visualise the feeling at the top of my mark, when my fingers feel the seam. It's all about trying to associate a feeling with a sensation. It's about what you want to feel when you touch the ball. We focus on some for my one-day cricket, and some for my Test cricket.

In the tape, he uses lots of words that I have already said to him. In the right ear, these words that I've asked him to use are asserted. *Top of your run. The ball is in your hands. The seam is in your fingers. You set the tone. You're patient. You're accurate. You'll build pressure. You've got one focus.* We have begun to share that we are both into music – his emails having subject headers of Charlatans or Stone Roses songs – and he suggests that I think in an artistic way. So, as an experiment, the left ear tells a different